VITyarthi

Digital Literacy – NGMC

Digital Literacy Project

Course Title – **Digital Literacy**

Course code – **CSE0001**

Slot – **D11**

Faculty – **Kannan Sir**

Type - **Project**

Submitted By :-

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Branch **: Integrated M.Tech AI**

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GitHub Repo Link - https://github.com/nandannikam/digital-literacy-project

Overview of the Project –

The project initiated with Task 1, which involved creating a Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic using Canva. Canva is a free online design platform that is accessible and offers a wide variety of icons, templates, and visual elements that can be used. The infographic is a single webpage that discusses three main concepts. These concepts include defining and understanding the real meaning of digital literacy, a list of beneficial digital tools that students can utilize for academic purposes, and basic guidelines on how to safely use the internet. The hardest part of this task was the discipline of condensation – learning to distill complex, multi-layered ideas into concise, readable statements without losing any accuracy – a skill that would prove to be not only foundational to design, but to all forms of digital communication encountered throughout the course. This task also added to the sense of responsibility inherent in the role of the Ambassador, as creating content intended to genuinely inform and educate others required accuracy, consideration for the audience, and a genuine engagement with the subject matter rather than a surface-level approach. Task 2 was then an extension of this foundation in the creation of a Student Digital Portfolio through the creation and configuration of professional profiles on GitHub, LinkedIn, and ResearchGate – three sites that cover all three aspects of collaboration, networking, and research engagement. A profile README repository was set up on GitHub, which has a structured introductory format for name, degree, expected year of graduation, and learning objectives. This has given way to a living, version-controlled digital identity that will only grow and evolve further in the next four years of the B.Tech program. The LinkedIn profile's Education section has also been fully completed to set up a professional baseline. ResearchGate has also been explored as an alternative platform for engaging with published research and academic communities, which is only in keeping with the prospective nature of an engineering education. The key takeaway from this task has been realizing that it is not enough to just be online, but it is essential to curate a set of profiles that not only cohere with each other but also serve as a purposeful and professional set of tools for communicating who you are, what you are learning, and where you are going.

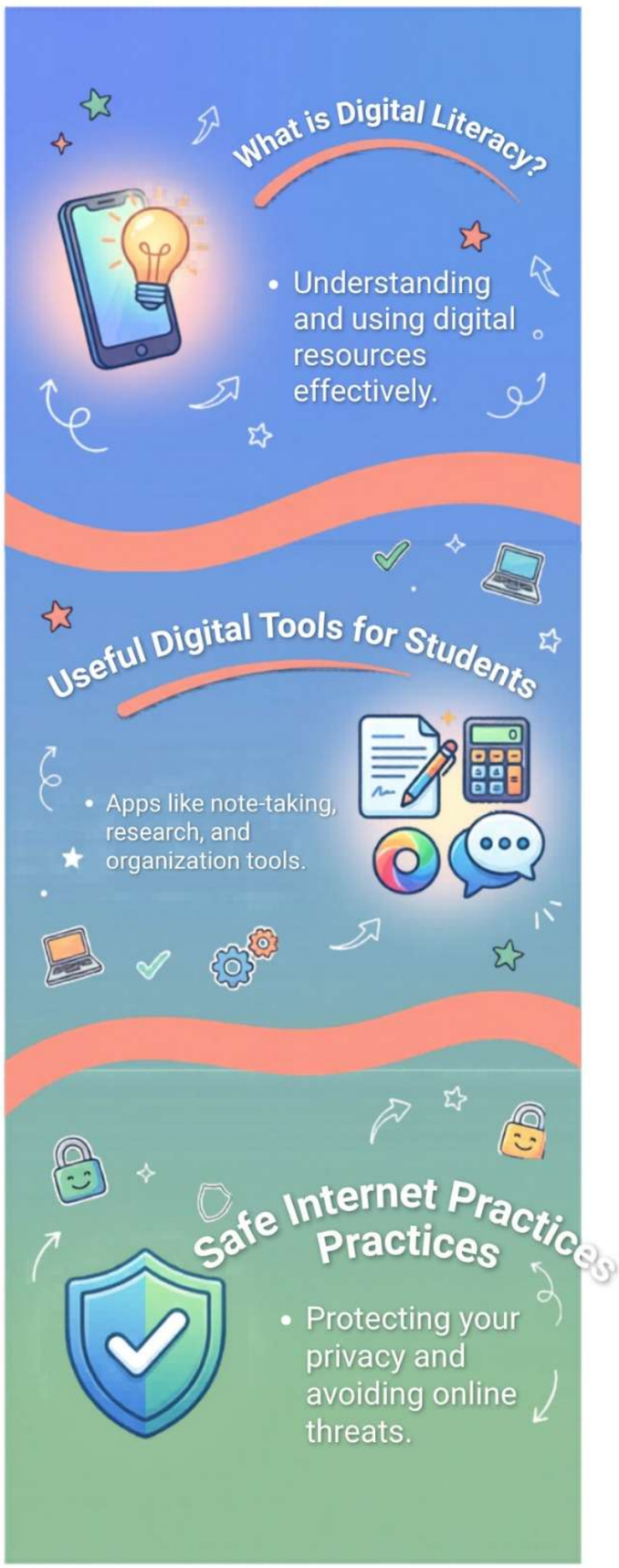
Task 3 was a broadening of the scope of the project to include the domain of coding practice and cloud-based collaboration, as it was realized that in a technical academic environment, digital literacy would not only involve the ability to solve problems individually but also the ability to work effectively with tools that facilitate a collective knowledge-sharing and data management environment. In the case of HackerRank, the five-star rating in the domain of Python was accomplished by completing a series of structured programming challenges that would involve logical thinking, the ability to manage input and output correctly, and the ability to ensure that the code was executed correctly in a variety of test cases. In terms of the collaboration aspect, a "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz" with five questions was created using Google Forms, with both multiple choice questions and short answer questions, including a question asking how the test-taker would recognize a phishing scam, and was linked to a Google Sheets document to organize the results in a readable format, providing a complete but simple experience in terms of creating a form, collecting results, and analyzing them. The link to the Google Form was embedded in the GitHub repository README file, making the quiz not only complete but also potentially usable with batch mates in the Digital Ambassador role rather than just remaining a hypothetical exercise. Task 4 then took a turn in terms of creating formal digital communications, something universally required but not typically formally taught in any

curriculum, by asking the creation of two formal emails: one to a professor asking for an extension on an assignment due date, and the other to an internship coordinator to express interest in an internship opportunity. Formal digital communications are something all students are ultimately required to do at some point in their academic careers. The written reflection for the task was informed by the instructive narrative of Priya, a student who sent a venting email meant for a personal friend to the entire project team, including the supervisor and the recipient of the criticism, leading to a disastrous breakdown in team trust and psychological safety. However, the reflection was also much deeper than the mere importance of carefulness in sending emails or messages, as it highlighted the permanent, public, and irreversible nature of digital communication, where every message sent has consequences that cannot be undone, and the importance of careful, empathetic, and deliberate digital communication in the workplace. The "Five-Minute Rule" of saving any emotionally weighted email as a draft before sending it was highlighted as a powerful personal habit, and the Social Media Do's and Don'ts checklist was a further extension of the learning in the much wider and even more public domain of social media websites, where the audience for poor digital communication could be so much wider and the damage so much more lasting.

The fifth and final task brought the entire project full circle in a socially relevant fashion by making the Cybercrime Awareness Case Study on the topic of UPI and online payment scams a task that was not only globally relevant but also personally relevant to the lives of the college students in India who used the apps for their daily transactions, as the case study revealed in great detail the ways in which these scams typically operate by utilizing psychological manipulation, fake payment requests, impersonations of trustworthy entities such as banks or the government, and the exploitation of the urgency response in a manner that bypasses rational thinking in the heat of the moment in a manner that reveals the unsettling reality that not only are these scams not targeting the ignorant but also everyone in the world due to cognitive shortcuts that everyone uses in life. The "Stay Safe Online" prevention checklist, which was developed in conjunction with the case study, provides over eight specific and actionable pieces of advice tailored to the needs and circumstances of college students in India, with particular focus on UPI-specific safety practices such as never sharing your UPI PIN under any circumstances, never scanning an unknown QR code sent by a stranger, always verifying the identity of any caller who claims to be from a bank or government body before sharing any information, enabling transaction limits on UPI apps as an additional layer of safety, etc. Perhaps most importantly, the prevention checklist prominently includes resources such as the National Cyber Crime Portal (cybercrime.gov.in) and the 1930 Helpline as official resources for reporting cyber-crimes, ensuring that anyone who accesses the prevention checklist is not only aware of how to protect themselves from cyber-crimes, but is also aware of where they can seek help in case they have already become victims of cybercrimes, thus breaking the culture of shame and silence surrounding victims of cybercrimes. The most surprising and profound finding that has been made through the course of the research for this task is that the reason behind the success of such scams is not the technical hacking of the systems themselves but the psychological hacking of the minds of people through the instigation of fear and the utilization of false authority and trust in a matter of mere seconds and that the duration of the process of the scam itself is less than anyone would anticipate. This has been the reason behind the development of a genuine and true personal pledge of never clicking on unsolicited links regardless of the level of authenticity they may possess, of never sharing any financial information in response to any incoming call or message, and of actively working towards the spread of awareness among the community through the utilization of the knowledge and the communication and technical skills developed through the course of the completion of all the other four tasks of this project itself.

Task – 1 : Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

Digital Literacy Infographic :-



For the first task, I created an infographic that visually demonstrates the importance of digital literacy for students. I used Canva to create this infographic because it’s an easy-to-use design platform that provides many template options and icon resources to help you create a professional-grade design without having to be a designer.

There are three distinct sections in my infographic which enable easy understanding of the subject matter:

- What is Digital Literacy: This section clearly defines what digital literacy means. It explains to the reader that digital literacy is about finding and using digital resources effectively and that it is not simply the ability to operate a computer.

- Helpful Digital Tools for Students: In this section, I provided examples of types of digital applications that students may use to assist them with their study, such as note-taking applications, research aids and applications that may help to manage schoolwork.

- How to Use the Internet Safely: In this section, I highlighted a number of common-sense practices that will help keep students safe while they use the internet, including protecting their identity and being aware of potential dangers such as scams and compromised computer security.

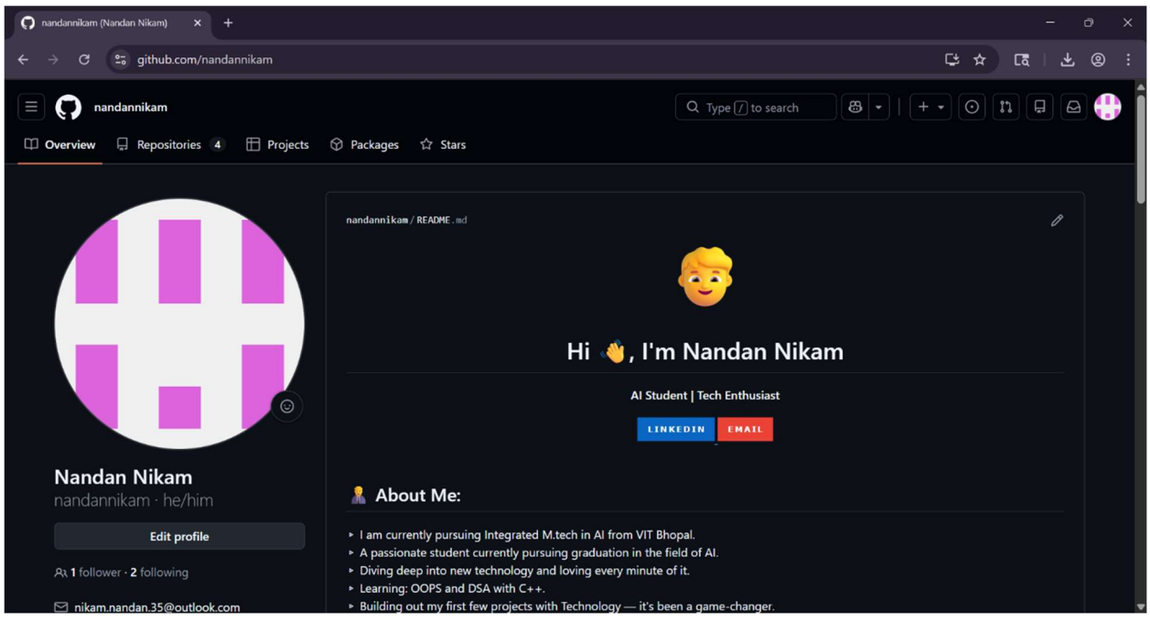
Doing this task as a Digital Ambassador has made me think about my role in helping people experience technology as less confusing. I can see how much we use the internet daily without really knowing how to be safe or what tools there are to make our lives easier.

Icons have the potential to tell stories when used properly - the example of a shield icon representing "safety" is a perfect example of how effectively an icon represents an idea without telling a lengthy paragraph.

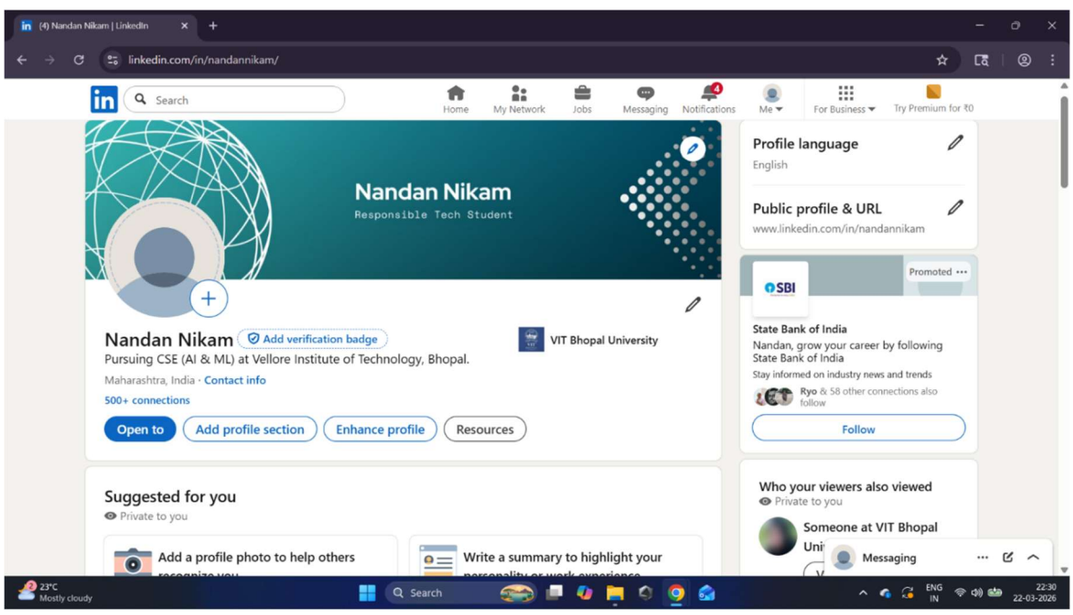
The hardest part of this project was shortening the text. I had a lot of content I wanted to share but needed to learn how to summarize my thoughts to make sure the slide didn't appear overloaded with information. I learned a great deal through this task and feel my design skills have improved while delivering a simple-to-understand message for anyone to follow.

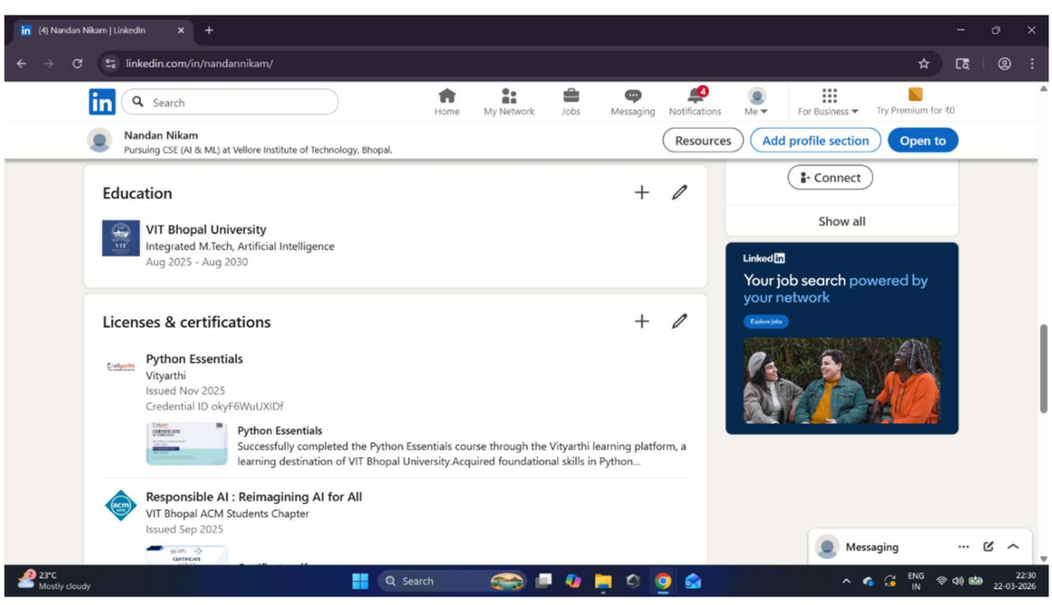
Task – 2 : Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

GitHub Profile :-

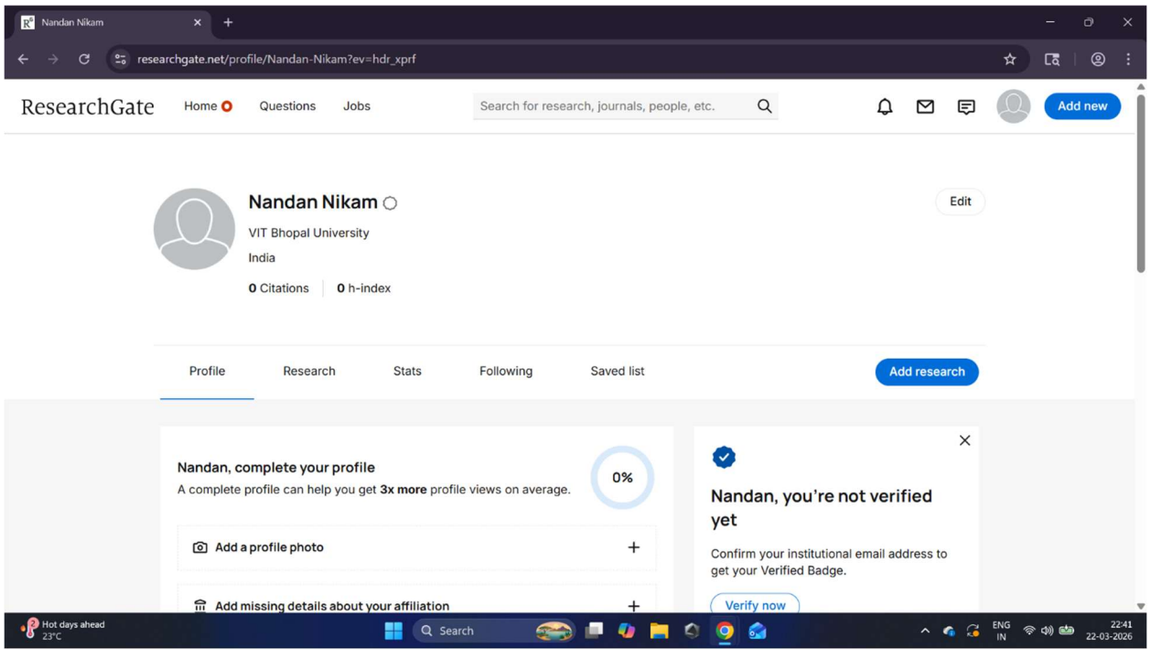


LinkedIn Profile :-





ResearchGate Profile :-



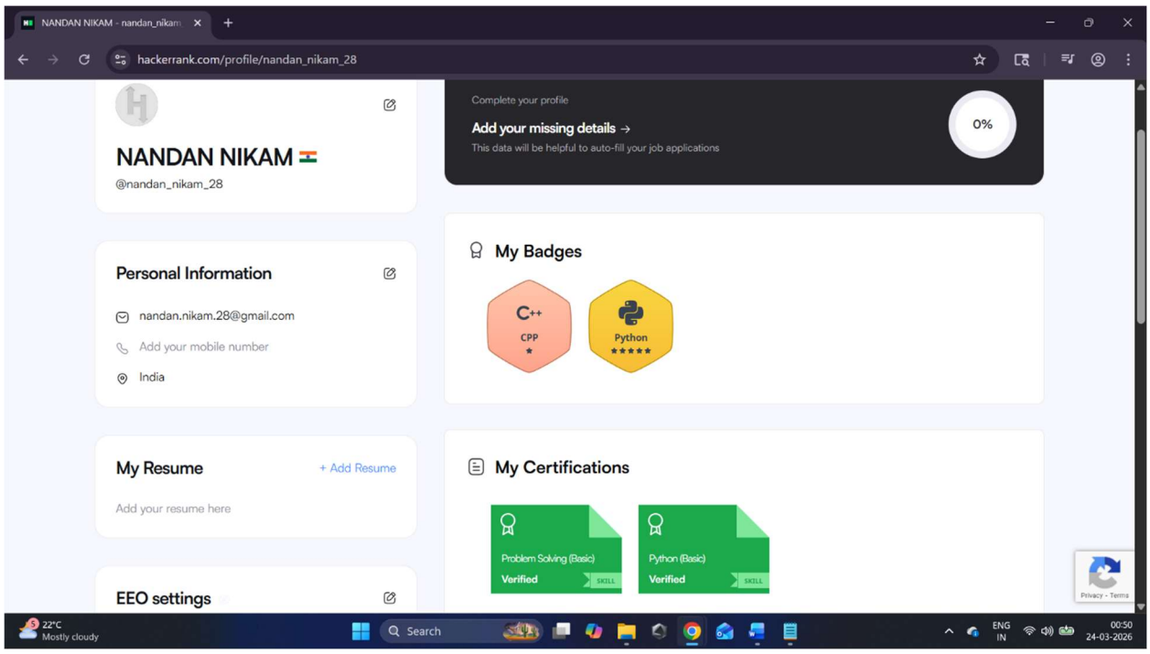
I have created my profile on GitHub and also created a special repository named after my username. The README is my digital introduction; it contains my name, degree (academic program) and expected graduation year. Additionally, it contains skills I know. GitHub is my primary application for handling versions of code. GitHub is where I host my projects and show my coding progress by keeping record of the changes I commit. It acts record of work for my future.

I have made my LinkedIn profile and I have made it more professional by completely formatting my Education section. I have entered my degree, school and expected graduation date. LinkedIn is my primary tool for creating and expanding my connections with experts of my field, helping me get an internship and jobs in my area of study.

I have used ResearchGate to study various research papers of publications. ResearchGate is a research collaboration network that allows users to upload papers, ask questions and work together. ResearchGate is focused on the academic side, which allows me to read various scientific papers and eventually afterwards share my own research papers.

Task – 3 : Explore Coding & Collaborative Platforms

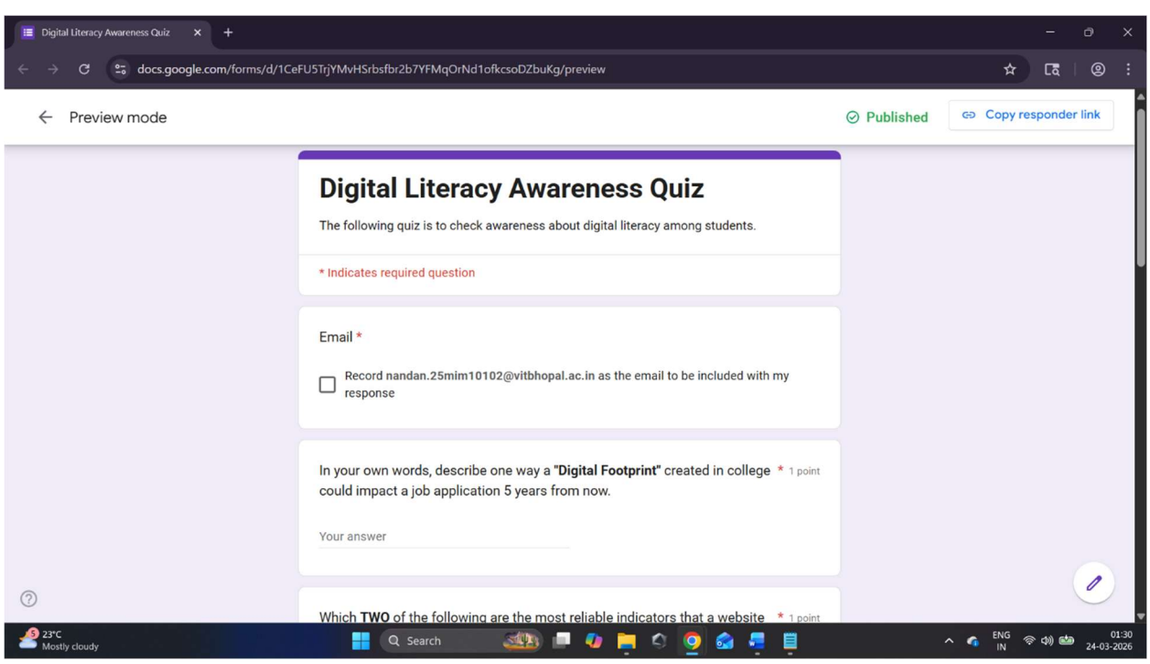
HackerRank Profile :-

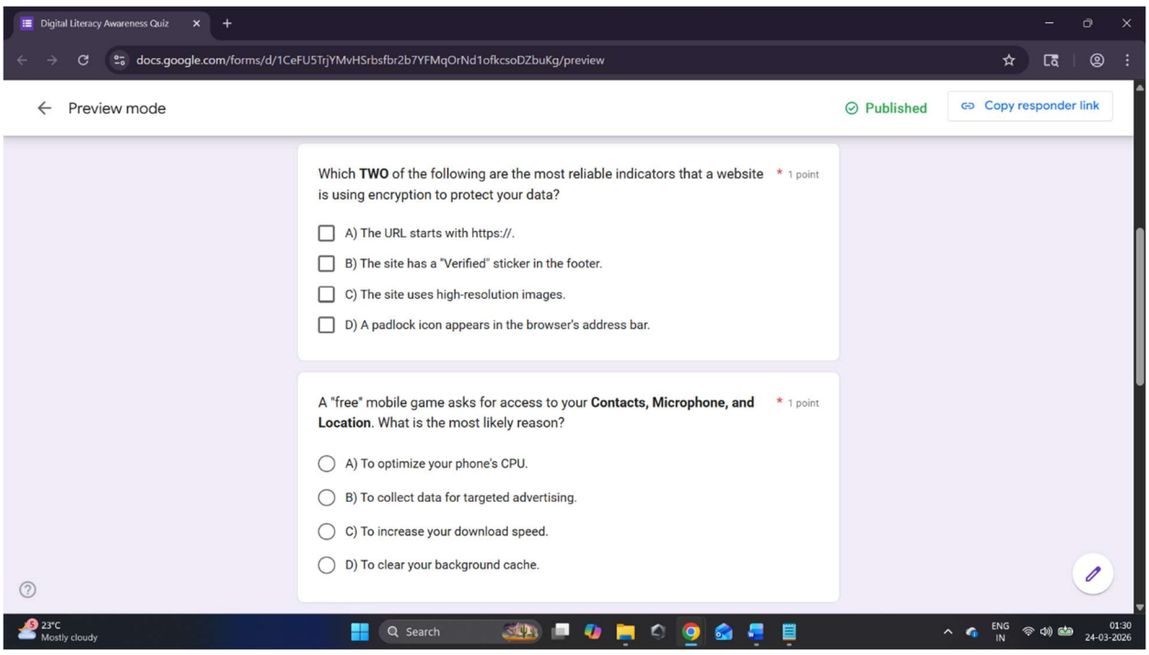


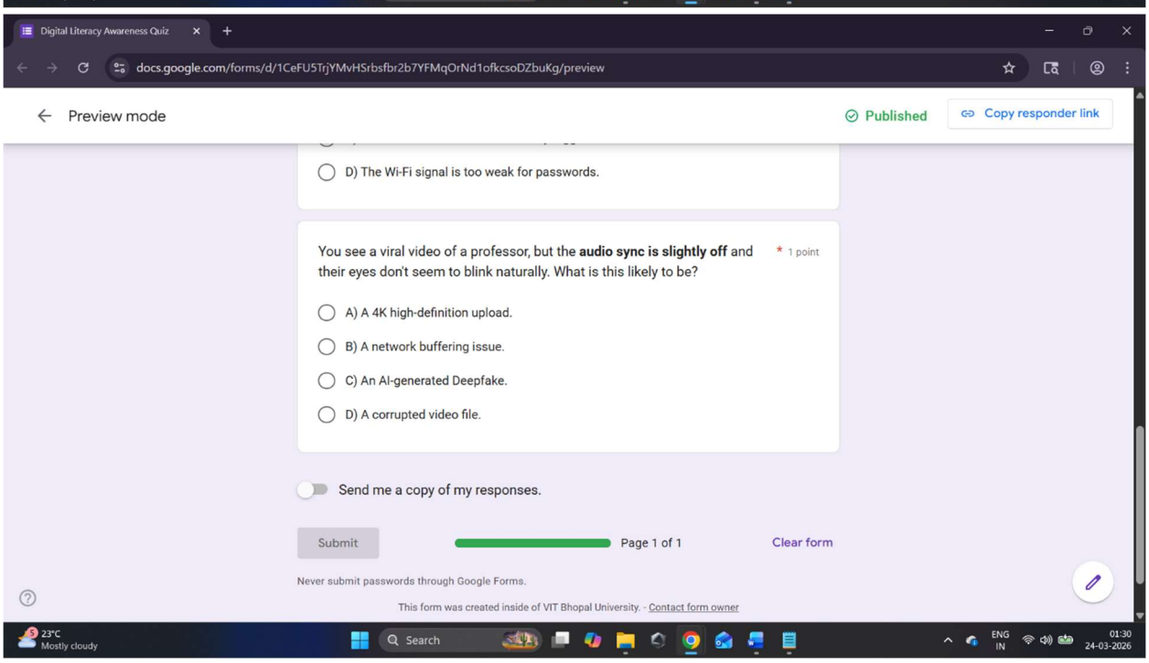
Google Form Link – https://forms.gle/PUvQKs76uJhtBUy47

Google Sheets Link – https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1NwjFv0v3IhJD-OuYEa1R_ZUn-jdL1cclgdb2GjO9p4w/edit?usp=sharing

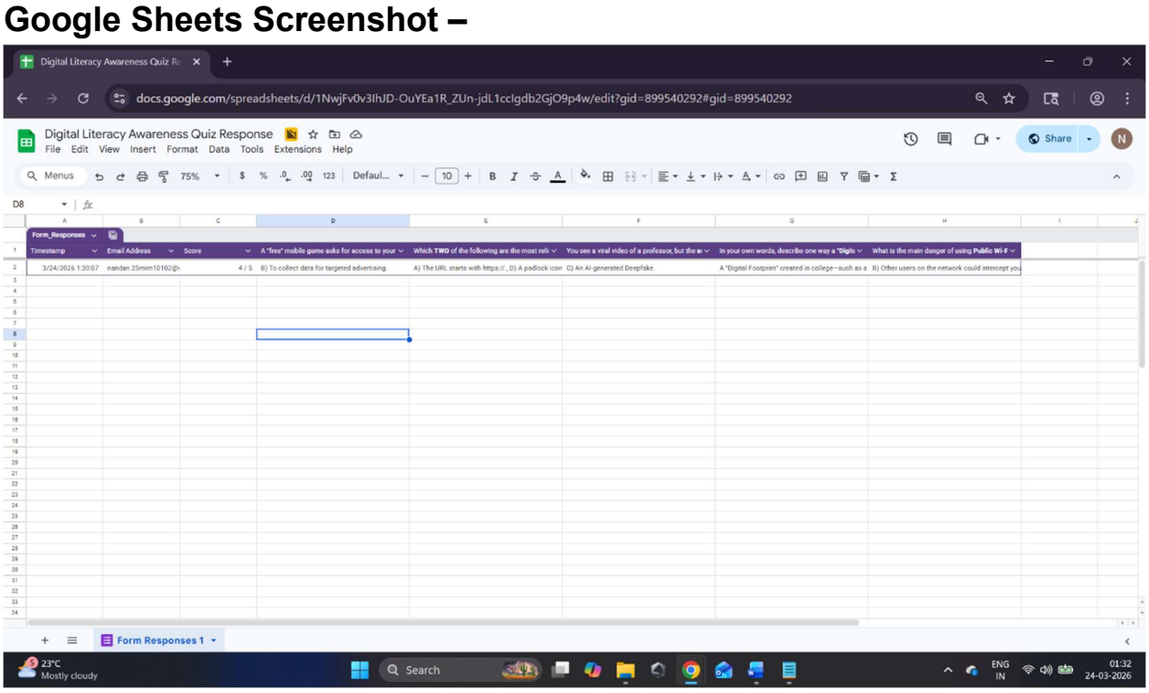
Google Form Screenshots –







Google Sheets Screenshot –



To complete this task, I have used HackerRank for coding challenges and practice and then used Google forms to create digital literacy awareness quiz.

I had successful got 5 stars in Python on HackerRank coding platform. For those coding assignments, I had to write logic to evaluate basic input data and then ensure the code execution with different test cases. Building the way to develop a structured, problem-solving approach that would help me while taking computer science classes.

I used Google Forms to develop a "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz" with five questions, including one multiple choice and one short answered question asking about how to identify phishing scams. The Google Forms survey was integrated into Google Sheets to keep the record of the responses in the Google Sheets.

Both of these platforms are very important for my academic success. HackerRank will prepare me for my technical rounds in interview by continuing to build my debugging abilities, and Google Workspace will facilitate my collection and communication of data while I am engaged in group research projects. By gaining experience on these tools, I will be fully prepared to contribute to an effective team while also maintaining high technical standards as an individual contributor.

Task – 4 : Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

During the course of a group internship project, a student named Priya planned to forward the team email to her friend venting about her colleague's repeated failure to meet deadlines, referring to the situation as 'completely unbearable' and the colleague as 'unreliable.' However, Priya ended up sending the email to the entire team, including the team supervisor and the colleague in question by accident.

What Should Have Been Done: Priya could have expressed her feelings in a very professional manner by talking to the team member in question about the repeated failure to meet deadlines. She could have talked to the team supervisor as well. If Priya needed to vent to her friend, she could have done it in a phone call rather than sending the email. The most important lesson here is the golden rule of digital communication: "Never write in an email or message something which you would not say aloud in a room full of all the people on the 'to' list."

Other than Priya's own reputation, one can imagine that the entire team's productivity probably plummeted after this incident. Conflicts between team members that are made public through these sorts of email mishaps create a breakdown in "psychological safety," which is defined by the idea that team members feel comfortable making a mistake or taking a risk without fear of being judged. Now, the team member who was publicly criticized feels unsafe and targeted by their own teammate, and all team members will be paranoid about what is being said behind their backs. It is an agonizingly slow process to rebuild that trust. However, this scenario shows that a single click can break months of team-building efforts and create a positive team environment into a toxic one.

To ensure that one is not the next Priya, it is essential for students and professionals alike to create barriers between their send button and their email composition. A very effective one is the "Five-Minute Rule," which states that if an email has any type of weight or criticism in it, save it as a draft and walk away for at least five minutes before sending it. Another is using "Undo Send" in Gmail

Task – 5 : Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

Having completed this project, I must say that my eyes are now opened to the reality of how prevalent UPI scams are in our nation. One thing I learned from this project is that it is not just uneducated people or elders in society who are being tricked by these scams, but smart and tech-savvy college-going kids like us are being tricked by these scams every single day. According to recent reports, India is receiving thousands of cybercrime complaints every month, and out of those thousands, a huge number of complaints is regarding UPI scams. What is even more alarming is that it takes less than 30 seconds for a scam to be successful once a person is tricked. This was a huge wake-up call for me, proving that being "good with apps" does not necessarily make us immune to these scams.

What I learned from this project that surprised me was that it is not just technical glitches that are used in these crimes, but psychological manipulation is used by these scam artists. They don’t necessarily hack into people's accounts; they hack into people's minds by using psychological warfare.

Going forward, I understand my responsibility as a Digital Ambassador goes beyond my own security. One thing for sure, in my life after undertaking this project, is that I would not click on any link sent to me by an unknown sender through an unknown message or text. This is because, through my learning, I have realized that no bank or any official entity would send a link asking for my login details or PIN to receive money.

Moreover, I have developed a sense of responsibility to enlighten my community. Many individuals are shy to come forward to report cases where they have been scammed. However, through enlightening my community on the availability of the 1930 Helpline and the National Cyber Crime Portal, I can help break the culture of silence in my community. Cybersecurity is a community effort, and through securing my own footprint, I can make my community a very difficult place for these scammers to operate in.